

text, for example RTTL encoding.

Polyphonic: Polyphonic means that multiple notes can be played at the same time using instrument sounds such as guitar, drums, electronic piano, etc. Many phones are now able to play more complex poly tones; up to 128 individual notes with different instruments are played simultaneously to give a more realistic musical sound. Mobile phone handsets manufacturers have taken full advantage of new technologies to improve speakers in order to produce better sound quality.

Polyphonic ring tones are based upon MIDI sequences, so they can pool in the 100+ different MIDI sounds. Many polyphonic-capable phones can play standard MIDI files; others play SP-MIDI, which is scalable polyphony, and depending on the number of channels the phone can play, the handset will render those many notes. On an old polyphonic-capable phone, one can play four notes at once, with flashier new handsets being able to render 128 notes at once. Many phones support SMAF (.mmf) files, which are based upon a sound format devised by Yamaha.

Music ring tones: They are a new version of ring tones, often called music ring tones, voice tones, real tones, sing tones or true tones. They use actual pieces of music, along with all lyrics and the entire song backing music, including backing singers. They are usually contained in the AAC, MP3, WMA, WAV, QCP, or AMR formats, which can be used as ring tones on many Series 60 or Symbian phones, and on smartphones. Many cell phone manufacturers, including Motorola, Nokia and Sony Ericsson, are including voice ring tones on most of their newly released phones.

The first real music ringtone was created by Richard Fortenberry and Brad Zutaut and was sent over the Sprint network. They were two of the founders of a company called Xington. The ringtone was from a song by the band Devo.